Tango^2: from the paper to Lean

A proof guide and a route to classical MultiSplay

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1 The theorem we are trying to finish

Fix an ordered set of n keys and a request word $X = (x_1, \ldots, x_m)$. A *binary search tree* (BST) stores each key once, with smaller keys in the left subtree and larger keys in the right subtree. A rotation is the usual local change of parent and child that preserves this order. The agreed cost of one request is its depth in the tree at the start of the request, plus one, plus the number of subsequent rotations. All computation used to select those rotations is free. Section 3 gives the precise model; this distinction determines which unfinished implementation work is relevant.

The minimal target uses $n = 2^{h+1}$, where h is a nonnegative integer, and a specified valid initial tree. It constructs one deterministic online strategy: its next state depends only on its present state and the current request. Write $\operatorname{clog}_2 k$ for the least nonnegative integer r with $k \le 2^r$, and OPT for the existing attained offline optimum, defined in Section 4. For a universal constant C, the desired bound is

$$\operatorname{cost}_{T^2}(X) \le C(\mathrm{OPT}(X) + n)L(h), \qquad L(h) = \operatorname{clog}_2\big(\operatorname{clog}_2(h+1) + 2\big) + 1. \tag{1}$$

Thus $L(h) = O(1 + \log\log\log n)$; the exact integer expression avoids undefined logarithms on small universes.

Status at this guide's preparation. The fixed online metadata strategy, its bound against this same optimum, and its conversion to ordinary search-and-rotation accesses are already proved. The public endpoint combining them on natural-number keys still needs assembly and audit. This is substantially less than proving the algorithm from scratch. Subsequent completion, including arbitrary universe size, is recorded in Section 21 and the adjacent `verification.txt`. The stronger local-program implementation in the imported paper remains a separate project; it is not a prerequisite for (1).

Sections 2–4 establish the shared framework. Sections 5–15 explain the Tango^2 proof and its correspondence to the paper. Section 16 sets the implementation boundary. Sections 17–19 explain the next, classical MultiSplay theorem. Section 20 specifies what counts as completion. "Checked" refers to actual Lean statements, including their hypotheses, rather than to a hand argument whose missing hypothesis happens to resemble the desired conclusion.

2 One project and one comparison framework

All developments live in this repository and use the root Lake project, Lean 4.32.1, and the same Mathlib version. The shared layer reuses the existing objects instead of introducing new mathematical copies. `DynamicOptimality.BST` is the indexed splay tree type; `DynamicOptimality.RawTree` is the existing ordinary key-tree type. The first records the exact interval of keys in its type. The second is convenient for local rotations, decorations, and relabeling. The map `BST.toRaw` preserves the tree, its keys, and its order.

An *algorithm cost* is a function of the initial indexed tree and the finite request word. For such a function A and a factor f, the shared assertion `CompetitiveAf` means

$$\exists C > 0\ \forall n > 0\ \forall T\ \forall X, \qquad A(T, X) \le C(\mathrm{OPT}(X) + n) f(n).$$

The constant is uniform in all four arguments. The additive n pays for initial state. The power-of-two, canonical-initial-state Tango theorem is initially a restriction of this scope, not yet this unrestricted assertion.

Development	Existing endpoint	Cost convention
Splay	`splay_competitive`	Requests plus standard splay rotations.
Greedy	`Greedy.competitive`	Geometric touches, starting from the surface determined by the initial tree.
Tango^2	`canonical_OPT_cost`	Fixed online physical metadata accesses, with a checked model conversion.
MultiSplay	Forest comparison and endpoint counter bound	Intermediate statements, not yet full competitiveness.

The new root entry point `DynamicOptimalityResults.lean` imports these results together. `AuditAll.lean` checks their namespaces, including private declarations. This is a shared source/build framework; it does not mean that a new public GitHub repository has been published. The existing nested splay Git history is preserved.

Cost conventions remain explicit. For standard splay, the number of rotations in an access equals the initial depth, so charging that depth as well changes the bound by at most a factor two. Greedy's geometric cost requires its own geometric-to-BST interpretation; calling all costs "the same" would hide that obligation. Both existing competitive results already use the same *comparison optimum*. No reproof of their analyses is part of finishing Tango^2.

Lean map. `DynamicOptimality/{Basic,Cost,SplayBound,SplayBlackBoxBound}.lean`; `Greedy/{Algorithm,Statement,Competitive}.lean`. The splay factor is `iteratedLog2n*(iteratedLog3n)^2`; a separate checked export `splay_eg_competitive` gives the black-box improvement.

3 The agreed abstract BST model

Definition 3.1. *An access to x from T to T' of cost c consists of a successful ordinary search for x in T, at depth d, and a finite sequence of r ordinary rotations from T to T', with $c = d + 1 + r$.*

Depth counts edges, so a root request costs one even when no rotations occur. Rotations may be performed at arbitrary nodes. Locating those nodes, deciding what to do, and maintaining auxiliary information have no separate charge. This does not permit replacing a tree for free: every changed parent-child relation must arise from the exhibited rotation sequence. The inorder key word is therefore invariant.

For example, a request at depth three followed by two rotations costs six. A long computation that discovers these two rotations still costs six. Conversely, rebuilding the whole tree is not free merely because the target shape has been computed: the rebuilding rotations are charged.

In Lean, `SearchRotation.Rotation` has the two root rotation constructors and the two context constructors allowing a rotation in either child. `Rotationsbeforeaftercount` records a finite sequence and its exact length. `Access` combines that sequence with `Tree.searchDepthkeybefore=somedepth`. `Execution` concatenates accesses with exactly matching boundary trees and sums their costs. This makes the order "initial search, then rotations" explicit.

An online strategy may additionally retain mathematical history and representation information. Its actual BST is an observable part of its state. Section 14 explains how a fixed choice of a next transition gives one strategy without depending on future requests. No claim about evaluation time, machine words, or an effective Lean program is being requested here. Finite rotation witnesses are still mandatory.

The imported paper imposes a stronger operational specification: one cursor starts at the root, movements and rotations are charged, metadata is read at visited nodes, and working storage is bounded. An ordinary *pointer trace* is a sequence of adjacent cursor moves, rotations, and services. Existing traces are useful certificates for our weaker cost model. However, synthesizing their choices by a bounded local controller is unnecessary. The guide preserves this substantive scope difference instead of presenting the abstract theorem as the full paper appendix.

Lean map. `DynamicOptimality/SearchRotationModel.lean` and `SearchRotationIndexed.lean`. The latter lifts raw rotations to indexed trees and proves the depth-change bound for a rotation.

4 The optimum and the lower-bound interface

The shared optimum is already defined and attained in the splay library. A *root-serving execution* performs arbitrary ordinary rotations before each request, places the requested key at the root, and pays one for service plus one per rotation. Its initial tree may be chosen freely. $\mathrm{OPT}(X)$ is the minimum of these costs, not an arbitrary assumed lower bound. Attainment supplies an actual minimizing execution.

We need two directions of comparison, for different reasons. First, any execution in Definition 3.1 bounds this shared optimum:

$$\mathrm{OPT}(X) \le 2\,\mathrm{cost}_{\mathrm{sr}}(X). \tag{2}$$

For one access of initial depth d and r prescribed rotations, bring the requested key to the root in d rotations, serve it, undo those d rotations, and perform the prescribed r rotations. This restores the exact required boundary tree. Work after a service can be attached to the next root-serving access; trailing work can be discarded. The cost is at most $2d + r + 1 \le 2(d + r + 1)$. No future request determines the local transformation.

In the reverse direction a sequence of r rotations bringing x to the root starts with x at depth at most r: one rotation decreases that depth by at most one. Its search-and-rotation cost is at most $2r + 1$. Consequently an optimal root-serving execution has a search-and-rotation witness costing at most $2\,\mathrm{OPT}(X)$. These small checked bridges already exist; no broad model-equivalence project needs to precede the target.

Second, the geometric lower-bound proof uses pointer traces. The shared library proves the existence of a pointer execution of cost at most $37\,\mathrm{OPT}(X)$. The underlying normalization postpones rotations outside the connected support needed for the current request. It preserves the relevant intermediate trees and moves deferred work to later accesses. This is precisely the issue raised by rotations at remote nodes; we reuse its completed proof rather than argue that reaching such a node is free in the pointer model.

Section 9 proves a rectangle count at most twice any pointer execution's cost. Composing with the 37 conversion gives a bound of $74\,\mathrm{OPT}$. Equation (2) then turns the final Tango bound into comparison with every actual competitor in the agreed model. We never need to define a new optimum for each algorithm.

Lean map. `OPT_attained`; `SearchRotation.OPT_le_cost`; `SearchRotation.exists_cost_le_OPT`; `exists_pointer_of_OPT`; `Splay.Accounting.OfflineConnectedNormalization`.

5 Primary paths: what an access changes

The *primary reference* is a fixed perfect binary routing tree whose leaves are the ordered keys. "Perfect" means that all leaves have the same depth; with height $H = h + 1$ it has $2^H = n$ leaves. Each internal vertex stores a preferred child. Following preferred children partitions the reference into preferred paths. A path has a top vertex and a terminal leaf. These are logical reference paths, not extra physical keys.

After requesting x, every primary vertex on the root-to-x route prefers the child containing x. Only edges that previously disagreed change. Let $F_1(X)$ be the total number of these primary preference changes. The *primary Wilber count*, $W(X)$, counts alternations between left and right requests at each fixed internal reference vertex, ignoring the initial preferred bit. Hence

$$F_1(X) \leq W(X) + (n - 1). \tag{3}$$

The additive term pays at most one initial disagreement per vertex.

Consider four leaves $0, 1, 2, 3$, initially preferring right at both levels. The active path ends at 3. Requesting 0 changes the root preference and then the preference in the left child, at depths $0, 1$. The active endpoint becomes 0. Requesting 0 again changes neither. This example also exposes the first-visit accounting issue discussed in Section 10.

A *head switch* replaces the continuation of the current preferred path by the continuation toward the requested leaf at its next wrong edge. The formal Tango algorithm processes these exits in increasing depth. Each switch generates one request to a secondary depth structure; one final completion request finishes the original access. Thus the number $D(X)$ of these inner requests obeys

$$D(X) \leq m + F_1(X).$$

This is a count of actual algorithm events, not a definition chosen to force the later bound. The chronological request state is updated after each original request; the preferred partition for a suffix starts from the partition left by its prefix.

The paper calls this part the abstract Cha-cha-cha tree. The formal objects retain its primary preferred-edge update and head-switch effect. Local balanced tree choices will differ, but the reference, the requested key, and the sequence of primary effects remain the same.

Lean map. `PreferredProjection`; `PrimaryFlipBound.lean`, especially `primary_flip_bound` and `depth_access_bound`; `AbstractBound.runMemory_serves`.

6 Secondary depth trees and persistent owners

Tango[2] applies another preferred-path decomposition to the depths along a primary path. The *secondary reference* is a balanced binary tree on depth labels $0, \ldots, h$. An internal node represents an interval $[a, b]$ split at a cut c: its left child contains depths below c, its right child depths at least c. A completion root adds the final depth $h + 1$. Its purpose is to finish the current request without losing genuine secondary history.

The central accounting decision is the identity of a secondary bit. It is indexed by a fixed depth interval and its *primary owner*: the primary ancestor at the interval's starting depth. An owner is a fixed vertex of the reference, not a temporary auxiliary tree. Therefore a bit survives when a preferred path splits, merges, or changes endpoint. Those operations change where its representation sits, not its history.

For one original request, retain its emitted exit depths lying in the bit's interval and belonging to that owner's root-to-request route. Write the corresponding left/right decisions in order. This is `requestWrites`. The final stored bit is the last write, or its previous value when there is no write. Initially genuine bits point right. Let $\mathrm{var}_b(w)$ denote the number of changes in a Boolean word w preceded by its initialized bit b. Then the exact cost is

$$M(X) = \sum_q \mathrm{var}_{b_q}(w_q(X)), \tag{4}$$

where q ranges over genuine owner/interval pairs and $w_q(X)$ is the concatenation of their actual writes. This is a proved regrouping of the chronological execution, not a reassignment of costs after the fact.

As a simple example, a right-initialized bit with writes left, left, right costs two, whether those writes occur in one preferred-path lifetime or three. Resetting it at a split would invalidate both its state and its cost. This persistence is also the main interface needed for MultiSplay in Sections 18–19.

The completion root has its own short word: left during the genuine depth requests and right at completion. It returns to its initial state after every original request and costs at most two changes per nonempty exit word. It must be accounted for, but must not be confused with a new genuine owner history.

Lean map. `MemoryKeys.lean`; `PersistentMemory.lean`, particularly `runMemory_preference`, `memoryCost_eq_histories`, and `completionWord_cost`; `CompletedDepthAccounting.lean`.

7 The geometric quantity used throughout

Encode the request word by the point set $P_X = \{(x_t, t) : 0 \le t < m\}$. Times are distinct even when keys repeat. A rectangle is determined by two input points at different times and different keys. It is *input-free* when its closed rectangle contains no other input point. In particular, points on its boundary cannot silently be ignored.

Two input-free rectangles are *robustly independent* if they share a defining point, or neither closed rectangle contains any corner of the other. A robust family is a finite family satisfying this pairwise condition. Write $R(P)$ for its maximum possible size. The maximum exists because all defining pairs come from the finite set $P \times P$. The weaker ordinary independence condition excludes only corners in the open interior. Thus $R(P) \le \mathrm{rect}(P)$, but the reverse inequality is neither asserted nor needed.

The paper's split argument partitions the ordered key set into intervals. A monotone map f replaces every key by its interval index. The *contracted instance* is $f(P)$, preserving times, while a *filtered instance* keeps only requests in one interval. Recursive splitting produces the hierarchy relevant to the secondary depth tree.

The *depth alternation count* of one split measures changes from a within-interval continuation to a departure from that interval, using the paper's convention for previous different keys. Summing these counts over the reference decomposition gives the LCA alternation count $A(X)$. Here LCA means lowest common ancestor: the deepest reference vertex shared by the relevant routes. The precise formal correspondence is important: `memoryLCA_eq_lcaBound` identifies the count extracted from persistent owner histories with this geometric decomposition count.

The proof has two independent geometric responsibilities:

$$A(X) \le 5R(P_X), \qquad R(P_X) \le 74\,\mathrm{OPT}(X).$$

The first pays for the algorithm's alternations and is explained in Section 8. The second compares a sequence-defined quantity with every competing BST and is explained in Section 9. Keeping the same robust maximum in both inequalities avoids an unjustified change of rectangle convention.

Lean map. `Rectangles.lean`: `InputFree`, `RobustPair`, `RobustFamily`, `robustBound`, `robustBound_le_rectangleBound`; `MemoryCountAssembly.lean`; `RobustCountingBound.lean`.

8 Why the split potential pays the LCA count

For a chronologically ordered point set P, let $s(P)$ count changes between consecutive keys. Let $t(P)$ count changes of direction in the key sequence with consecutive equal keys suppressed, and put $e(P) = 1$ if $s(P) > 0$, otherwise 0. The formal definitions use previous and next different points, so repeated columns are handled without deleting their chronological positions. Define

$$\Phi(P) = 5R(P) - 4s(P) - t(P) - e(P). \tag{5}$$

This is integer-valued and contains subtracted terms. The nonnegativity theorem is a real part of the proof, not a consequence of a natural-number truncation.

For a split given by f, let $a_f(P)$ be its depth alternation count, and let P_i be its filtered instances. The crucial inequality is

$$a_f(P) + \Phi(f(P)) + \sum_i \Phi(P_i) \le \Phi(P). \tag{6}$$

Its proof combines three identities or inequalities. Switches decompose exactly, except that some points are switches in both the contracted and filtered instance. The $-4s$ term pays these double counts. The turn term pays the desired alternations except for mixed turns, whose two relevant points lie in one interval but whose direction is interrupted by another interval. The robust rectangle construction pays those mixed turns, including the reverse-time cases. Adding the three estimates cancels all internal error terms.

Apply (6) recursively down the split decomposition. Every non-root potential appears once on the left of its parent's inequality and once on the right of its own inequality. They telescope. Nonnegative potentials at the leaves can be discarded, giving

$$A(X) \le \Phi(P_X) \le 5R(P_X).$$

The primary Wilber count also has a robust-family certificate, so $W(X) \le R(P_X)$. No separate unproved geometric lower bound is inserted at this stage.

The formalization follows the paper's potential proof, with two local repairs. An absent guard must be placed at the previous point's column, not one unit to its left, to keep the claimed strip empty. In the reversed mixed-turn case, the triple has to be ordered (q, h, h'), rather than (q, h', h). Repeated keys require the correct last occurrence before the next different point. These changes preserve the intended charging argument and are recorded separately from implementation changes.

Lean map. `Potential.potential_split_release`; `MixedGuard.lean`; `TurnPotentialRelease.lean`; `RobustCountingBound.sequence_lcaBound_robust` and `primaryWilber_robust`.

9 The robust rectangle lower bound for actual BSTs

An *arborally satisfied* point set has a third point in every axis-aligned rectangle determined by two points with distinct keys and times. Such sets encode the geometric constraints imposed by successful BST accesses. The lower-bound proof first constructs a satisfied superset from an actual pointer execution, then extracts distinct witnesses for its robust input rectangles.

The construction uses a *touch history*: each key is labeled by the last time its connected access region was visited. A connected rooted region, or hull, consists of its touched vertices together with their rootward paths. Maintaining a max-heap order on last-touch times lets a new hull access extend the satisfied point set. The initial tree contributes a fictitious initial row only for the invariant; that row is removed before the final witness count. This is why the resulting lower bound has no extra additive n.

For a robust family of one orientation, every rectangle receives a distinct horizontally adjacent pair in the satisfied superset. Robust independence prevents two different rectangles from consuming the same pair. Shared columns require explicit boundary cases; the proof does not assume all requested keys are distinct. Separating the two orientations and counting the witnesses gives

$$R(P_X) \le 2\,\mathrm{cost}_{\mathrm{pointer}}(X). \tag{7}$$

Apply this to the pointer realization of the attained optimum from Section 4. The result is the already checked theorem

$$R(P_X) \le 74\,\mathrm{OPT}(X). \tag{8}$$

Thus the lower bound needed for the target is complete.

There is a genuine statement-level issue with a sharper ordinary rectangle inequality in the paper. For requests $5, 0, 10, 5$, five pairs of request times form an ordinary independent family under the open corner convention. The fixed tree rooted at 5 with children $0, 10$ serves the word at pointer costs $1, 2, 2, 1$, totaling six. The displayed inequality $\mathrm{OPT}_{\mathrm{pointer}} \ge \mathrm{rect}(X)/2 + m$ would demand at least 6.5. Lean checks the family and execution. This refutes that sharp formula under that convention, not an asymptotic ordinary rectangle bound. Our proof consistently uses (8) instead.

Lean map. `RobustBSTLowerBound.lean`; `RobustPrivateCut.lean`; `BSTHistory.lean`; `SharedOPTBound.robustBound_le_shared_OPT`; `RepeatedKeyRectangleExample.lean`.

10 From persistent writes to the abstract work bound

Let $F_2(X)$ be the number of genuine secondary preference changes plus completion-root changes. Let $A(X)$ be the LCA count from Section 7, and $W(X)$ the primary Wilber count from Section 5. The checked secondary estimate is

$$F_2(X) \le 2A(X) + 2W(X) + 5(n-1). \tag{9}$$

The proof applies the exact history decomposition (4) to each fixed owner bit. Within one request its increasing exit depths produce a monotone write block. Compressing such blocks separates regular alternations from mixed blocks. Regular alternations are charged to A, mixed blocks to actual primary changes, and initial conditions to the number of genuine bits. Summing uses the linear total number of owner/interval pairs; completion changes are included separately.

The paper's assertion that a bit changes at most once on its first visit is false for the stated rightward initialization. In the four-leaf example from Section 5, the first request to 0 emits depths $0, 1$. The interval $[0, 2)$ split at 1 receives left and then right. Its right-initialized bit changes twice. Lean checks this example as `first_visit_can_flip_twice`. The repaired per-owner argument allows two regular charges, two mixed-block charges, and an additive three per genuine memory bit before the global simplification.

Define *abstract work* $Q(X) = D(X) + F_2(X)$, where D counts the actual inner requests including completion. Equations (3) and (9), together with $D \le m + F_1$, give

$$Q(X) \le m + 2A(X) + 3W(X) + 6(n-1).$$

Substitute $A \le 5R$ and $W \le R$ to obtain

$$Q(X) + 6 \le m + 13R(P_X) + 6n. \tag{10}$$

The constants are deliberately loose. What matters is that all terms count actual persistent operations and the only initialization allowance is linear in the fixed primary universe.

Equation (10) is not by itself a BST upper bound. To finish that step we must represent the maintained preferred-path state by one tree and pay for actual rotations between consecutive represented states. Sections 11–12 provide exactly that bridge; a purely numerical accounting certificate would not suffice.

Lean map. `OwnerFlipBound.lean`; `SecondaryFlipBound.secondary_flip_bound`; `MemoryCountAssembly.memoryLCA_eq_lcaBound`; `RobustCountingBound.abstract_work_robust_bound`.

11 Representing the paths by balanced auxiliary trees

A secondary preferred path is stored in a balanced auxiliary tree. Its ordered word records the path's routing labels; its gaps attach the other represented components. A *port* is one such attachment position. A *marked port* additionally identifies a boundary that must survive a local operation. These are representation data, not new keys in the final ordinary BST.

The formal relation `PathDecomposition.Represents` says recursively that a physical component represents the required source decomposition. Its consequences include the correct leaf word, a clean balanced core, valid marked ports, and a size bound. "Equivalent" balanced cores may have different shapes, but must retain the same ordered labels and attachments. This flexibility permits ordinary split and join routines without forcing a particular red-black-tree shape.

The paper uses red-black auxiliaries. Lean reuses the weight-balanced operations behind `Std.DTreeMap`. What is needed is their checked logarithmic split/join/access cost, not their precise colors or rotations. The completed midpoint secondary reference has height at most

$$k = \operatorname{clog}_2(h+1) + 1.$$

Every stored secondary preferred path has at most this many routing vertices; restricting the reference to a suffix cannot increase its height. Thus balanced auxiliary operations cost $O(1 + \log(k+1))$, the third logarithm in the final factor. It would be incorrect to balance a whole primary path and charge $O(\log h)$ for every event: the second decomposition is what reduces the auxiliary size.

An inactive primary path uses a *suffix reference*: only the depths at or below its start are relevant. A boundary sentinel describes how this suffix attaches to the rest of the representation. Genuine owner bits are distinguished from these structural boundary conventions. Changing a boundary does not create a fresh history for the suffix. This distinction is preserved by `componentSource`.

The physical transformation theorems carry surrounding trees as contexts. A local change therefore implies a change of the global represented tree with all untouched frontier subtrees preserved. This is the reason a local split/join bound can be composed into a legal single-tree execution. It is not enough to show that before and after components have equal key sets: the proof also supplies the rotations connecting them.

Lean map. `PathDecomposition.lean`: `Represents`, `initialize_represents`; `MaintainedPrimaryComponents.lean`; `ReferenceHeight.completed_midpoint_height`; balanced auxiliary split/join and source-trace modules.

12 The maintained invariant and one complete request

The global logical state consists of the primary preferences, every persistent secondary bit, and a component table indexed by primary endpoints. The assertion `Components.Valid` requires each relevant component to represent its active or suffix source under precisely those preferences. It relates all three pieces; independently valid components with stale memory would not satisfy it.

For one head switch, the proof exposes the relevant secondary boundary, separates the old continuation, attaches the incoming continuation, and repairs the represented contexts. The old and new endpoint components change; unrelated components remain valid. The key theorem `Components.Valid.head_exchange` both proves the new invariant and agrees with the specified primary and secondary memory update. Its physical companion supplies the actual source-tree trace and its cost.

Iterating this operation follows the actual increasing-depth head list of the request. The head loop ends at the primary preferred partition specified by the requested key. The final completion operation resets the completion root, visits that key, and leaves genuine owner histories as dictated by their writes. The maintained state can therefore be used unchanged as the starting state of the next request.

For a secondary reference B, put

$$q(B) = 10^7\big(\operatorname{clog}_2(\operatorname{height}(B^+) + 1) + 1\big),$$

where B^+ is its completed depth reference. The deliberately generous constant absorbs the balanced representation operations. If u is the genuine memory-change cost for one request and v its primary flip count, `maintained_physical_request` supplies a represented leaf visit with cost at most $(u + v + 1)q(B)$ and a valid output component table. There is no assumed simulator or unproved cost premise in this theorem.

The ordinary-key storage conversion then yields an actual metadata access of cost at most $7(u+v+1)q(B)+3$. The initial and final physical trees are the storage encodings of these exact maintained states. This is the bridge used by `transition_exists`; it does not merely assert that some unrelated cheap BST execution serves the same request word.

This request-level specification already supplies what the agreed model requires. The later local-controller branch tries additionally to discover the necessary components by bounded local reads. Free computation removes that extra discovery obligation while retaining every physical rotation.

Lean map. `MaintainedPhysicalHeadStep.lean`; `MaintainedHeadLoop.lean`; `MaintainedCompletion.lean`; `MaintainedPhysicalRequest.lean`; `MaintainedBSTMetadata.lean`.

13 One ordinary BST, with each original key once

The intermediate representation is leaf-oriented: original keys occupy leaves and internal vertices route between gaps. Such a tree is useful for composing secondary components, but it is not the final BST model. The storage theorem converts it to an ordinary node-storing BST with the same ordered original keys, each exactly once.

The conversion attaches the needed routing and leaf information to records at ordinary keys. Erasing a record's metadata leaves the original key. Its correctness theorem states that the inorder word of the erased tree is exactly the source leaf word. In the canonical construction this word is $0, 1, \ldots, n-1$. Consequently no sentinel or virtual depth label becomes an extra physical search key. The source has many logical names; the physical key universe does not grow with them.

An ordinary metadata access is a trace of adjacent moves, rotations, service, and metadata updates. Erasing metadata preserves actual ordinary rotations. Reads and writes leave the underlying key tree unchanged. Thus the representation bound from Section 12 becomes a pointer trace with no larger cost and exactly the same erased endpoints.

There is still one subtlety when converting that trace to the agreed model: it may rotate before it first reaches the requested key. The initial search depth is nevertheless at most the cost of the trace minus its service unit. The checked connected-prefix argument tracks the vertices that must be exposed before the service. Separately, the number of rotations extracted from the trace is at most its cost. Therefore a pointer access of cost p gives

$$\text{an access with the same endpoints and cost } c \leq 2p. \tag{11}$$

The new access first searches its initial tree and then executes those same rotations. This is a proof about the exact physical trees; it does not use a constant-finger simulation hypothesis.

The state theorem `State.tree_word` exposes the erased tree to the online interface. Starting with the canonical distinct increasing word proves ordering and key uniqueness for every state reached by the strategy. Relabeling its nonnegative integer keys to naturals is then a representation conversion, not an algorithmic change. The public endpoint should present this natural-key version so it composes directly with `BSTOn` and `List(Finn)` in the shared framework.

Lean map. `GapBST.Storage`; `Auxiliary.Metadata`; `GlobalPrimaryOnlineState.State.tree_word`; `SearchRotationDepth.pointer_access_initial_depth`; `SearchRotationMetadata.pointer_access` and `metadata_access`.

14 Fixing one online strategy

An existence theorem for each complete request word does not establish an online algorithm: different future suffixes could choose different prefix trees. The construction avoids that problem by choosing at the level of one state and one request.

For a maintained state s and current request x, the theorem `transition_exists` supplies a nonempty type of valid transitions. Each transition contains its output state, its actual metadata access, its cost bound, and equality of its memory update with the prescribed abstract update. Fix one such transition once and for all by classical choice, and call it $\mathrm{step}(s, x)$. Define the run recursively:

$$\mathrm{run}(s, []) = (s, 0), \qquad \mathrm{run}(s, xX) = \mathrm{continue}(\mathrm{step}(s, x), X).$$

Here "continue" uses the output state of the chosen transition and adds its cost to the recursively obtained suffix cost. The choice has no argument for the future word X.

For any two words U, V, the checked append theorem states that running UV is exactly running U, continuing from its resulting state on V, and adding the costs. Both the state equality and the cost equality are important. A theorem only comparing two numerical upper bounds would not establish this prefix consistency.

The fixed physical choice must survive later conversions as well. A second fixed choice per state and request selects the erased pointer access to the *same* next state. Its recursively summed cost is bounded by the original metadata run. The final search-and-rotation wrapper should do the same using (11); selecting a whole converted execution afresh for each word would throw away this stronger guarantee unnecessarily.

This is a deterministic mathematical strategy even though the Lean definition is noncomputable. Classical choice fixes a function; it does not grant the function access to future requests. Its witnesses contain finite rotation sequences and therefore establish legal finite accesses. We make no assertion that Lean can evaluate the chosen function as a program. That is the agreed abstraction, so turning this into a finite search algorithm or a bounded controller is not on the critical path.

For arbitrary initial trees, initialization should be chosen independently of requests, charged once on the first request, and omitted on an empty word. The existing pointer initialization does this with cost at most $18n$. It must not be rerun at every suffix or preferred-path lifetime.

Lean map. `OnlineStateSpecification.{step,run,run_append}`; `GlobalPrimaryOnlineState.{pointerStep,pointerCost_append}`; `GlobalPrimaryOnlineInitialization.lean`.

15 Assembling the bound and tracking constants

Let $c_{\mathrm{meta}}(X)$ be the cost of the one fixed online metadata run from the canonical state. The maintained request theorem, summed along that run, and the abstract count yield

$$c_{\mathrm{meta}}(X) \le 7\big(m + 13R(P_X) + 6n\big)q(B) + 3m. \tag{12}$$

For the midpoint depth reference, Section 11 gives $q(B) \le 10^7 L(h)$ and $q(B) \ge 1$. Also $m \le \mathrm{OPT}(X)$, since every request pays one unit in the attained optimum. Use (8) and absorb $3m$ into the factor $q(B)$:

$$\begin{aligned} c_{\mathrm{meta}}(X) &\le \big(7(m + 13R(P_X) + 6n) + 3m\big)q(B) \\ &\le 6744(\mathrm{OPT}(X) + n)q(B) \\ &\le 67\,440\,000\,000(\mathrm{OPT}(X) + n)L(h). \end{aligned}$$

This last inequality is the actual theorem `canonical_OPT_cost`. It concerns the fixed online run, not merely the existence of a cheap execution for a known word.

The pointer wrapper has no larger cost. The final per-step search-and-rotation conversion costs at most twice as much. Thus the planned canonical endpoint has the explicit safe constant

$$c_{\mathrm{sr}}(X) \le 134\,880\,000\,000(\mathrm{OPT}(X) + n)L(h). \tag{13}$$

Combining this with (2) gives comparison with every agreed-model competitor E:

$$c_{\mathrm{sr}}(X) \le 269\,760\,000\,000(\mathrm{cost}(E) + n)L(h).$$

These constants are proof margins, not performance predictions. Reducing them would not advance the requested theorem.

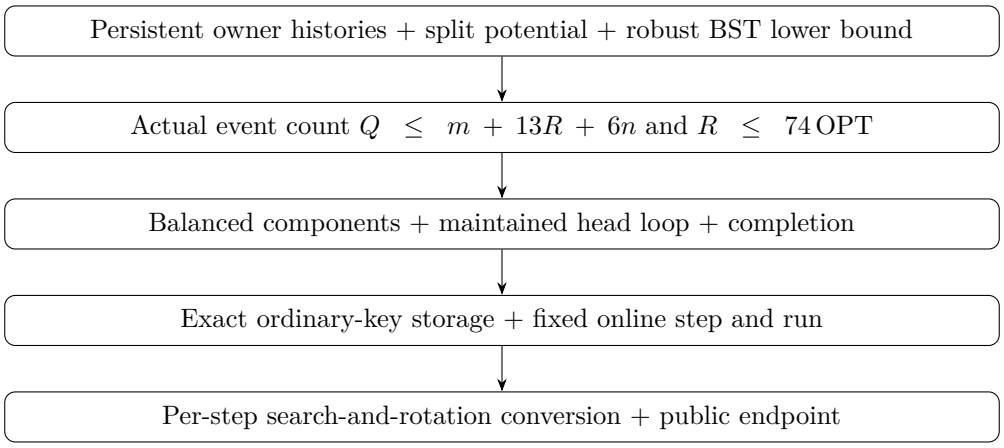
Remaining assembly. The natural-key online wrapper must prove the exact input and output tree identities, its actual execution theorem, its append law, and (13). The constituents above are already checked, but a prose composition should not be reported as an exported Lean theorem before this wrapper and its axiom audit pass.

The minimal scope is the canonical initial tree on 2^{h+1} keys. The arbitrary-initial-tree wrapper may then add the one-time linear initialization cost. General n requires a separate padding or restriction argument preserving the original physical keys. It is not licensed by simply increasing the type-level universe and adding dummy search keys.

Lean map. `OnlineStateAccounting.{run_cost,canonical_cost}`; `OnlineSharedOPT.canonical_OPT_cost`; `GlobalPrimaryOnlineState.canonical_pointer_OPT_cost`; `BSTRectangleBound.midpoint_request_factor`.

16 The minimal dependency path and what to defer

The proof's logical dependencies are shown below. An arrow means that the downstream statement uses the upstream result; it does not assert that every historical module is part of this path.



The last box is the remaining assembly priority. Work on every stronger machine model should stay off this path. In particular, bounded local record discovery, prepared incoming cursors, cached header refresh, constant-register code generation, and a persistent single-finger simulation are not required by Definition 3.1.

This is a change to the completion plan, not evidence that those earlier lemmas were wrong. Many are checked and may support the stronger paper implementation later. Preserve them and their proofs. The shared public entry point should import the required mathematical route, while the larger historical umbrella remains available for a full build and audit. Deleting thousands of dependent source lines would create risk without simplifying the theorem's assumptions.

The paper-to-Lean deviations are now explicit: weight-balanced instead of red-black auxiliaries; root-first secondary repairs with the same interval update; repaired first-visit accounting; a robust lower bound valid for repeated keys; and an abstract online cost model instead of a bounded local program. The first two change representation choices, the next two repair mathematical arguments, and the last changes the operational scope of the theorem. They should not be conflated.

Finish in this order: package the fixed natural-key transition; prove its execution and prefix laws; derive the bound by the existing inequalities; audit the common project; then decide whether the already available linear initialization wrapper is worth exposing immediately. Do not start arbitrary-universe padding or model-equivalence generalizations before the minimal endpoint is reviewed.

Lean map. Short entry point: `DynamicOptimalityResults.lean`. The large historical entry point is `TangoSquaredPaper20261030.lean`. This guide supersedes older completion lists that made local controllers mandatory for the current abstract target.

17 Classical MultiSplay: the exact algorithm matters

The requested next result concerns classical MultiSplay, not a newly defined Tango^2 variant that merely replaces its balanced auxiliaries by splay trees. Classical MultiSplay uses a fixed node-storing reference BST and represents its preferred paths by splay trees on the original nodes. A splay operation moves its requested node to the root by the standard zig, zig-zig, and zig-zag rotations.

For now use a perfect reference on $n = 2^H - 1$ keys, of height H. Its external gaps provide $n + 1$ ordered leaves for comparison with leaf-oriented arguments, but these gaps are not additional keys. Every preferred path has at most H stored keys. The request visits wrong proper ancestors in decreasing depth and then performs the mandatory final switch at the requested node. This order differs from the increasing-depth Tango head loop and must be transported explicitly.

The appropriate interface is a *forest event word*: a chronological list of root-splay searches, splits that splay and remove a specified pivot, and raw root joins that put a specified pivot above two specified components. Component identities and their ordered key domains are part of the word. A raw join is not an arbitrary rebalancing operation.

For a left-to-right switch at y, let U be the preferred prefix above y, L its old left tail, and R the incoming right tail. Let ℓ and r be the closest lower and upper ancestor keys of y in U. When both exist the prescribed word is

$$\begin{aligned} &\mathrm{Split}(y), \quad \mathrm{Split}(\ell), \quad \mathrm{Split}(r), \\ &\mathrm{Join}(A, \ell, \varnothing), \quad \mathrm{Join}(R, r, B), \quad \mathrm{Join}(A', y, B'). \end{aligned}$$

Here A, L are the daughters of the lower-guard split, and the upper-guard split isolates B from the empty gap beside y; A', B' are the first two joined results. The old tail L remains as a parked component. Missing guards omit their operations; right-to-left switching is reflected.

A comparator must execute this exact word on these domains. A cheap Tango^2 tree serving the same original requests is not automatically such a comparator. This exact-word transport is the main remaining mathematical step for MultiSplay.

Lean map. `multisplay/common-forest-normal-form.tex`; `multisplay/multisplay-competitiveness.tex`; the switch and replay modules imported by `MultiSplay.lean`. Original algorithm: Wang–Derryberry–Sleator, SODA 2006.

18 What the common-forest splay theorem already gives

Fix a forest event word W as in Section 17, and a capacity K bounding every live component's number of keys. A *comparator program* is an actual sequence of permitted operations on these components, executing exactly W, with total budget B. It may choose different internal shapes from splay, but it must respect the same split pivots and join domains. A *distinct splay trace* is the supplied actual standard-splay execution of that word, with no duplicated keys anywhere across the live forest.

The checked common-forest theorem states that there is a universal C such that

$$\mathrm{cost}_{\mathrm{splay}}(W) \le C(N_0 + r_0 + B)g(K), \qquad g(K) = \mathrm{iteratedLog}(2, K)\,\mathrm{iteratedLog}(3, K)^2. \tag{14}$$

Here N_0 is the sum of the sizes of the initial components, r_0 is their number, and `iteratedLog` applies the stabilized binary ceiling logarithm repeatedly. The theorem assumes equal initial inorder words, a capacity certificate, and the condition that each join fits the capacity. Its conclusion concerns the supplied actual run, not some alternative splay trace selected by the proof.

The difficult persistence issue has already been formalized: splitting a component creates daughters whose histories inherit the parent's state; joining components does not replenish their initial credit. The proof passes through a persistent forest normalization and a packed comparison, then transports the bound back using determinism of standard splay. Empty components and permitted component permutations are handled in the interface. There is one global initialization allowance, rather than a new $O(K)$ charge for every short-lived component.

For classical MultiSplay, $K = H$, and the initial preferred-path forest partitions n keys, so $N_0 = n$ and $r_0 = O(n)$. What remains is to supply the cheap comparator program for its exact forest word and to relate the whole physical BST access cost to that replay. The theorem is not conditional on an unproved splay competitiveness hypothesis; it reuses the already checked shared splay analysis. Its *input comparator* is still a real obligation.

This is why the extension should reuse the common forest API instead of rerunning the splay proof separately for each preferred-path lifetime. The latter would lose the persistent accounting on which the desired small factor depends.

Lean map. `MultiSplay.CommonForest.forest_splay_bound` in `CommonForestSplayBound.lean`; `DistinctSplayTrace.deterministic`; `DistinctSplayTrace.toPointer`.

19 The MultiSplay extension: proved counters and the gap

Let S count actual classical MultiSplay switches, including final switches, and let F_{act} count variation in the fixed-owner secondary ledger of that exact chronological emission stream. For a perfect node reference, Lean already proves

$$m + S + F_{\mathrm{act}} \le 2\,137\,120\,\mathrm{OPT}(X) + 21n. \tag{15}$$

This uses an endpoint-copy embedding, an arbitrary interval-hierarchy lower bound, and a checked change-of-order argument. The primary state may start arbitrarily; the secondary ledger is initialized rightward. The theorem concerns the actual switches, not a sorted substitute word.

The hand draft `tango-common-forest-comparator.tex` proposes the missing comparator. Its path component has genuine secondary interval histories plus a structural boundary spine for the suffix beginning at its top depth. A local depth request and splice should cost $O((1+f)\lambda)$, where f counts its genuine bit changes and $\lambda = O(1+\log\log H)$. Structural boundary repairs must preserve all deeper owner histories.

The proposed transport has three concrete obligations. First expose the two external gaps adjacent to the switched key; their search paths contain both existing ancestor guards. Second collect the touched vertices into rooted skeletons, leaving identical untouched frontier subtrees. Third reconfigure only these skeletons to insert the prescribed three split and three raw join checkpoints. No rotation may cross a current forest-component boundary. This must also work with empty tails and missing guards. A generic same-key-set rotation theorem alone would charge whole components and lose the required factor.

If this construction is proved, deleting omitted writes from each fixed Boolean history cannot increase variation. It yields a comparator budget $B = O(n + \lambda(S + F_{\mathrm{act}}))$. Combine with (15) and (14), with $K = H$, and the global physical charging described below, to obtain:

$$\mathrm{cost}_{\mathrm{MS}}(X) = O\big((\mathrm{OPT}(X)+n)\lambda g(H)\big) = O\big((\mathrm{OPT}(X)+n)(1+\log^{(3)} n)^2(1+\log^{(4)} n)^2\big).$$

Here $\log^{(j)}$ denotes j repeated logarithms, stabilized at small inputs. This is the proposed extension's factor; it is not the single third-logarithm factor of Tango[2].

After the comparator, prove that the unchanged classical algorithm's global search depth and rotations are charged to its actual switch splays, including the final switch. Only then assemble competitiveness. General-n padding and any sharper black-box splay factor come later.

Lean map. `MultiSplay.EndpointEncoding.perfect_reference_actual_counters_le_OPT`; `multisplay/composition-audit.tex`; `multisplay/tango-common-forest-comparator.tex`. The latter remains a hand proof to formalize and audit.

20 Completion criteria and an audit trail

The first deliverable is a public theorem for a fixed online Tango^2 strategy on the agreed power-of-two universe, with its actual initial tree and the search-and-rotation bound in Section 15. It must expose enough of the strategy to check that every step serves its requested key and transforms the same tree used by the next step. A theorem with a user-supplied cheap simulator or a missing representation invariant is not this deliverable.

The endpoint should export four connected facts: the inorder word of every boundary tree is exactly the original key range; the selected steps form an actual `SearchRotation.Execution`; appending requests preserves the already chosen prefix state and cost; and that cost obeys the shared-OPT bound. The competitor corollary then follows from `SearchRotation.OPT_le_cost`. If arbitrary initial trees are exposed, their initialization is performed and charged once, with an empty word leaving the supplied initial tree unchanged.

At the project root the reproducible commands are

```
make lean
make audit
make guide
```

The Lean build uses the common dependency cache and serializes builds through the workspace lock. The audit collects axiom dependencies of public and private declarations in the shared, splay, Greedy, Tango, and MultiSplay namespaces. It accepts only the standard logical axioms `propext`, `Classical.choice`, and `Quot.sound`. No `sorry`, new assumption, or unchecked native proof is permitted. An axiom audit validates proof dependencies; reviewing theorem hypotheses and definitions remains necessary to validate the mathematical scope.

The authoritative source locations for this guide are the preserved 30 October paper under `tango_squared/imports/2026-10-30-Tango2/paper/`, the corresponding Lean namespace `TangoSquared.Paper20261030`, the shared `DynamicOptimality/` directory, and the existing `multisplay/` drafts and formalization. Corrections to the imported paper are recorded in `PROOF_REPAIRS_2026_10_30.md`; the original archive is not silently edited to match the formalization.

At the preparation of this document, the lower bound and fixed-strategy metadata cost theorem are complete; the natural-key abstract endpoint is the next assembly task. Classical MultiSplay has a checked persistent forest comparison and actual counter theorem, but the exact-word physical comparator and final BST assembly remain. Local-controller implementation, arbitrary-universe padding, and broader machine-model comparisons are explicitly deferred. Subsequent endpoint changes should be recorded in a short dated verification note rather than retroactively treating this planning snapshot as if it had already contained them.

21 Completion: removing the universe-size restriction

After the initial twenty-page proof review, the abstract endpoint was completed and then extended to every finite universe. This section records the additional argument. Write $\pi_n(T)$ for *prefix pruning*: retain the keys smaller than n in an ordered tree T. Recursively, a retained root keeps its two pruned children; a root at least n is replaced by its pruned left subtree. Its entire right subtree is too large to survive.

One ordinary rotation projects to zero or one ordinary rotations. If both rotated keys survive, perform the same rotation. If exactly one survives, the two pruned shapes coincide; if neither survives, they also coincide. The impossible ordering of a retained larger key above a deleted smaller key is excluded by BST order. Context rotations lift recursively. Also, a search for a retained key follows its old route with some vertices removed. Thus an entire access projects to an access with the exact pruned endpoints and no larger initial search depth or rotation count.

For arbitrary $n > 0$, choose $h = \operatorname{clog}_2 n$ and $N = 2^{h+1}$, so $n \le N \le 4n$. Run the completed strategy on this virtual universe, but make its *actual* BST $\pi_n(T)$. Its internal state retains the virtual state as free bookkeeping. Fix each projected transition using only that state and the current original request. The shared online interface then supplies actual executions and exact prefix consistency. No virtual key appears in the physical BST.

Extend a supplied initial n-key tree by placing it below a new root n with the remaining larger keys on the right. Pruning recovers the *exact* supplied tree. The same extension of any competitor adds one to each original search depth and leaves its rotation count unchanged. The two shared root-service conversions from Section 4 give $\mathrm{OPT}_N(X) \le 6\,\mathrm{OPT}_n(X)$. With $C = 134\,880\,000\,019$, the completed power-of-two bound therefore yields

$$\mathrm{cost}_n(X) \le 6C(\mathrm{OPT}_n(X) + n)L(\operatorname{clog}_2 n).$$

Finally, write $\ell_j(n)$ for the shared stabilized j-fold logarithm. The checked numerical bound $L(\operatorname{clog}_2 n) \le 4\ell_3(n)$ gives the public theorem `DynamicOptimality.Tango2.All.third_log_competitive`:

$$\mathrm{cost}_n(X) \le 3\,237\,120\,000\,456(\mathrm{OPT}(X) + n)\ell_3(n).$$

It uses the unrestricted shared `Competitive` definition, every initial BST, and the actual search-and-rotation cost. The empty universe has only the empty request word and costs zero. Only the stronger local machine implementation and the classical MultiSplay extension remain outside this completed theorem.

Lean map. `SearchRotationProjection.lean`; `OnlineBSTProjection.lean`; `UniverseExtension.lean`; `PaddingSize.lean`; `PaddingFactor.lean`; root `TangoSquaredAll.lean`.